TOPIC 03 · INTERACTIVE DASHBOARD
LAB 10 THEME · INTERACTIVE DASHBOARD

Lab 10 — Make the Hiring Dashboard Interactive and Visual

Maps to	LO3: turn the KPI formulas into an interactive, visual dashboard - linked charts, a metric switch, conditional-formatting alerts, protection and a Gemini summary exported to Google Docs
Duration	30 minutes
Tools	Google Sheets · Insert > Chart (linked) · Gemini actions (dropdown, conditional formatting) and formulas · Export to Docs · OrchidBay_Dashboard_Interactive.xlsx
Mock data	data/OrchidBay_Dashboard_Interactive.xlsx
Course	Gemini for Google Sheet (C817) · v2.0
Prompts	https://tertiarycourses.github.io/C817-Gemini-for-Google-Sheet/prompts/#lab-10

Goal

Finish a one-page hiring dashboard whose charts, alerts and KPIs all respond to the dropdowns - and prove it with three test views.

What You Will Do

The KPI formulas from Lab 9 are ready: dropdowns in C3:C4 drive the KPIs and three tables. You will add charts that are linked to those tables (unlike Gemini-inserted charts, which are static copies), so they redraw when a dropdown changes. A third dropdown switches the monthly chart between Applications and Hires, and conditional-formatting alerts flag a low hire rate and a slow time to hire. You will hide the gridlines, protect the formulas, and ask Gemini to summarise the dashboard for the Head of Talent.

What You Will Build

OrchidBay_Dashboard_Interactive: a protected Dashboard tab with three linked charts, a metric switch, KPI alerts and a Gemini summary exported to Google Docs

Prerequisites

- Lab 9 completed, or its Test It values to hand.
- This lab folder downloaded, including data/OrchidBay_Dashboard_Interactive.xlsx.

Data note

Use only the supplied fictional Orchid Bay data or information you are authorised to process. Do not paste credentials, confidential business material or real candidates' or employees' personal data into Gemini, the AI function or a Gem unless your organisation has approved it.

Steps

Step 1. Download OrchidBay_Dashboard_Interactive.xlsx from this lab's data folder. In Google Drive choose New > File upload, open the uploaded file, then choose File > Save as Google Sheets - Gemini works best on a native Google Sheets file. Close the .xlsx tab and work only in the new Google Sheets copy. At the top right, click Ask Gemini (the spark icon) to open the Gemini side panel. Read the About_This_Data tab before you prompt.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
Required state:
File : OrchidBay_Dashboard_Interactive (Google Sheets copy)
Dashboard : C3 Position and C4 Source dropdowns (All) | KPIs B7:H7 | tables B10, E10, I10
Check : B7 = 720 and E7 = 41 with All / All
```

Step 2. Ask Gemini how to make charts that update, then build three yourself: select E10:G19 > Insert > Chart > Line chart; select B10:C14 > Insert > Chart > Bar chart; select I10:J17 > Insert > Chart > Column chart. Drag them into a grid below the tables.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
ASK GEMINI:
How do I insert a chart from a range on this tab so that it updates when the values in the
range change?
```

Step 3. Test interactivity. Set C3 to Customer Success Executive: the KPIs show 103 applications and 7 hires, and all three charts redraw. Set C4 to Referral, then put both back to All.

Step 4. Add a metric switch. Type Show in B5 and apply the dropdown action. Type ="Monthly "&C5 in H10, insert Gemini's formula in H11 and fill it down to H19. Then edit the line chart (double-click > Setup > Data range) to use E10:E19 and H10:H19. Switching C5 to Hires now redraws the line.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
ACTION:
Create a dropdown in Dashboard!C5 with the options Applications and Hires.

FORMULA:
Create a formula for H11 that returns F11 when C5 is "Applications" and G11 when C5 is
"Hires".
```

Step 5. Add alerts, one action at a time. Test them: Operations Supervisor turns F7 red (4.3%); HR Executive turns F7 red (3.5%) and H7 amber (39.3 days).

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
ACTION:
1) Highlight Dashboard!F7 in light red when it is below 5%.
2) Highlight Dashboard!H7 in amber when it is more than 35.
3) Add a white-to-green colour scale to Dashboard!J11:J17.
```

Step 6. Polish it yourself: View > Show > untick Gridlines; right-click the Lists tab > Hide sheet; Data > Protect sheets and ranges > protect the Dashboard tab except C3:C5, so viewers can use the dropdowns but cannot break the formulas. Then set C3 and C4 back to All and ask Gemini for a summary. Check its numbers against B7:H7, then click Export to Docs.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
ASK GEMINI:
Summarise what the Dashboard tab shows in five bullet points for the Head of Talent, using the
KPI row and the three tables. Mention the best month, the best source for hires and one risk.
```

Step 7. Prompt_Log already lists every prompt in this lab with its step. Ask Gemini to recap the conversation, copy each line into What Gemini did, add How I verified in your own words, and choose Keep, Revise or Undo in the Decision dropdown. Google Sheets saves automatically. Tip: the side-panel history is lost when you reload the page, so insert or copy anything you want to keep.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
LOG:
List the prompts I sent you in this conversation. For each one, give a one-line summary of
what you did, so I can copy it into the Prompt_Log tab.
```

Sample Prompts

Use these prompts in the Gemini side panel in Google Sheets (or adapt them). Name the tab and columns, state the output, and always verify the result. The same prompts are in sample-prompts.txt in this lab folder.

Copy-ready prompts online: https://tertiarycourses.github.io/C817-Gemini-for-Google-Sheet/prompts/#lab-10

#	Purpose	Prompt
1	Image	Create an image of a simple header banner with an orchid and the words Hiring Dashboard.

#	Purpose	Prompt
2	Layout	Suggest a clean layout for this dashboard: where should the KPIs, charts and selectors go?
3	Alert	Highlight the Hires cells in the monthly table that are 0 in light grey.
4	Number format	Format F7 as a percentage with one decimal place and G7:H7 with one decimal place.
5	Review	Review this dashboard for a colleague: what is unclear, and what would you add?

Test It

Check	Expected result
Linked charts	Three charts built with Insert > Chart from E10:G19 (or E10:E19 + H10:H19), B10:C14 and I10:J17.
Customer Success Executive	103 applications, 7 hires, 6.8%; all charts redraw.
Metric switch	C5 = Hires changes the line chart and the H10 header to 'Monthly Hires'.
Alerts	Operations Supervisor: F7 red (4.3%). HR Executive: F7 red (3.5%), H7 amber (39.3).
Polish	No gridlines, Lists hidden, Dashboard protected except C3:C5; summary exported to Docs.

Checkpoint

Lab 11 moves to the final decision: 16 finalists for four roles, screened with a Gem.

Troubleshooting

If this happens	Fix
The chart doesn't change when you change C3.	It was inserted from the Gemini panel (a static copy) or from the wrong range. Delete it and use Insert > Chart on the Dashboard table.
The line chart shows Applications and Hires together.	Edit the data range to E10:E19 and H10:H19 only.
The F7 alert never turns red.	F7 holds a fraction (0.043), not 4.3. The rule must be 'less than 0.05' - open Settings or Format > Conditional formatting to check.
Viewers can't use the dropdowns after protection.	In Protect sheets and ranges, tick 'Except certain cells' and add C3:C5.

Challenge

Add a 'Data as at' note in A2 that comes from a formula (e.g. ="Data as at "&TEXT(MAX(Applications!C2:C721),"yyyy-mm-dd")).

Reflection

Which three people would use this dashboard, and what would each of them need protected or hidden?